



Canonical murder facts

Grant Larceny dies from the conservation reference toxin wiped into his clean empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44. The glass arrives clean at 6:40, is covered and continuously guarded from 6:44, is poured at 6:46, and is watched through the 6:49 toast. One attending guest acts alone. Linen and preparation access are shared.

Select the murderer animal before Motive. Every player uses one stable branch throughout all three rounds. Each innocent reveals suspicious misconduct plus an individual clearing fact. Recovered records cover 6:39–6:45; SECURITY timestamps are synchronized and BRASS overlays run ten minutes fast. F4 authenticates source intervals and integrity, withholding identities and private contents. Testimony supplies the personal connection; the fixed evidence never asserts a named guest was elsewhere regardless of branch. Continuous films, sealed-room logs and fixed live calls are distinguished from their portable or automatic counterparts. F5 supplies clock corrections. Prerecorded clips, mobile calls, automatic tests and shutter metadata cannot establish personal presence. All necessary proof is available before voting and independent of absent characters.

The murderer has no valid matching clearance. Each guilty route uses its own uncorroborated or contradicted account; an impossible cabinet visit is no longer a universal tell. Compare the whole three-round account, contamination interval and exhibits, rather than selecting whoever admits a scandal. Every innocent also has one. The laboratory does not name the killer.

All three highest-voted attending suspects read Coming Clean after ballots lock, even if a confession occurs early. If none confesses, call the retained selected animal. The confession reconstructs already available facts. Complete evidence permits clearing every innocent, as requested; this logical property is not a measured human difficulty guarantee.



Artie Ficial

Victim relationship: Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Hidden complication: You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Motive / innocent: Grant wanted my resignation, his name above the door and veto power over every purchase. I had another offer. At 6:39 I took the recruiter's call on the boardroom speakerphone and stayed until 6:45. I accepted. Kindly allow me to tell my trustees before the caterer tells them.

Motive / murderer: Grant wanted my resignation and veto power over every purchase. I had another offer, but announcing my departure under his conditions would have handed him the museum. The recruiter rang during preparations. I let the boardroom line take the call; I had a donor to manage before discussing another job.

Opportunity / innocent: I left Grant's speech cards in the salon before six-thirty. Then I borrowed the boardroom for what I called a budget discussion. It was a job interview. After the call I went back to the gallery, where everyone wanted a photograph and nobody wanted responsibility for the naming agreement.

Opportunity / murderer: I delivered Grant's speech cards before six-thirty and returned to the gallery. Around 6:42 I was checking the dedication wording on the working copy at the reception desk. He had complained about his name twice. Later I went to the boardroom to deal with the waiting recruiter.

Method / innocent: I removed the draft resignation from Grant's folder. He had left a space for my signature beneath a date he had chosen himself. The dedication card and naming agreement were still in the folder; I took the page concerning my job. My acceptance of the other directorship is signed. His agreement is not.



Method / murderer: I tore the draft resignation out of Grant's folder and retained his dedication card. If you have found a sheet with my name and an empty signature line, that is mine. He expected me to supply the stationery for my own dismissal. The board had not approved the naming agreement he meant to announce.

Innocent Coming Clean: I concealed my new appointment, not a murder. The recruiter's retained call places me at the fixed boardroom speakerphone throughout the contamination interval. I took the resignation page because I refused to have my dismissal displayed beside the bowl. I shall answer to the trustees for that, preferably after dessert.

Murderer Coming Clean: I let the recruiter leave a message. While I should have been answering, I took toxin from conservation and wiped Grant's empty coupe with museum linen. The speech cards got me into the salon. I claimed I was fussing over his dedication at reception. I wanted him gone before he could turn my resignation into his victory.

Technical support / F4: Boardroom speakerphone / SECURITY clock.

Claire O'Scuro

Victim relationship: You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Hidden complication: Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Motive / innocent: Grant knew the provenance file had a hole in it. He wanted my name under a label pretending otherwise. I commissioned an independent review against the board's instructions. Its fee came out of an exhibition account. You may question my authority to spend it; you will not improve the title by suppressing the question.

Motive / murderer: Grant knew exactly what was missing from the provenance file. He threatened to remove me if I made it public. I



commissioned an independent review and charged it to the exhibition. He was preparing to call that financial misconduct while presenting the bowl as immaculate. I had no intention of applauding either performance.

Opportunity / innocent: I checked the exposed cradle during installation, well before the mounting alert. Then I took the disputed file into the Registrar's vault. I wanted to compare the export papers without Grant leaning over my shoulder. When I came out, he had moved on to his toast and the exhibition label was still wrong.

Opportunity / murderer: I checked the cradle before the alert, then worked at the Registrar's outer desk. I made another pass by the gallery around 6:43. The curtain was down; I looked at the label copy on the desk instead. I was deciding which sentence I could defend when Grant called me insubordinate.

Method / innocent: The file I carried into the vault had a white correction tab sticking out of the cover. I stayed inside until the custodian let me out at 6:45. I concealed the independent review behind the 1988 manifest. That was deliberate. An exhibition account should not pay for vanity, including a donor's.

Method / murderer: I put the white correction tab in the provenance file at the outer desk and substituted a cautious label. The independent review is behind the 1988 manifest. I charged its fee to the exhibition without board consent. Grant wanted a clean public record; he was about to receive a substantially less flattering one.

Innocent Coming Clean: I used exhibition money without authorization and hid the resulting report. The vault record and interior camera cover my whole stay while Grant's glass was exposed. My correction tab identifies the file I described. I could have ended the exhibition by publishing that report. I did not end his life.

Murderer Coming Clean: The review was real. My shelter in the Registrar's Office was useful fiction: I stayed at the outer desk, then went to Grant's glass. I stole the reference toxin, used museum linen to coat the empty coupe and returned to the paperwork. I wanted my research to survive him. I made certain that it would.



Technical support / F4: Registrar vault / SECURITY clock.

Hugh Bidder

Victim relationship: Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Hidden complication: You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Motive / innocent: The certificate was forged before it reached me. Grant proposed an elegant correction: I refund millions and let everyone believe I made it. I altered my file after the sale because I looked like a fool. That alteration was mine. The forgery was someone else's. Grant enjoyed blurring the distinction.

Motive / murderer: Grant wanted millions back for a certificate forged before I saw it. He also wanted the pleasure of calling me a forger in public. Yes, I altered the sale file afterward. Clients pay for confidence; I supplied some I had not earned. Grant discovered a very expensive way to make me listen.

Opportunity / innocent: I argued with him in the salon before the glass arrived. From 6:39 until 6:45 I used the fixed auction-booth handset to renegotiate the sale. 'Violet reserve' was the buyer's absurd password. I had to admit the altered file. A six-minute confession to a client is quite enough for one evening.

Opportunity / murderer: I argued with Grant before the glass arrived, then took the buyer's call on my mobile in the gallery. I moved to the side passage for a quieter connection and came back before the toast. A threatened lawsuit is best conducted without an auctioneer supplying commentary over your shoulder.

Method / innocent: I changed the chronology in the certificate file after the sale. The buyer's refund instructions are folded behind it. Grant could make that alteration sound like the original forgery if he left out the dates, which



he intended to do. My client was about to learn what my confidence had cost them.

Method / murderer: The amended certificate file was in my jacket beside the buyer's refund instructions. I changed its chronology after discovering the forgery. Grant had a copy of the earlier version and wanted a valuation left in his salon. He could never decide whether my paperwork was worthless or urgently required.

Innocent Coming Clean: I concealed an alteration to my sale file. The recorded bid-booth conversation, including the ridiculous password, kept me away from the exposed coupe. I have lost a client and probably a substantial fee. I did not poison Grant. If anyone still wishes to acquire the bowl, we should begin with its actual ownership.

Murderer Coming Clean: The client was waiting while I made a different adjustment. I went to the salon, took the stolen toxin onto a museum cloth and coated the empty coupe. My mobile call could follow me anywhere; the recorded bid-booth conversation was not mine. Grant intended to sell my reputation back to me. I killed him before he could collect.

Technical support / F4: Bid booth / SECURITY clock.

Monet Bags

Victim relationship: Grant demanded that you disguise several gala and naming-wing expenses inside restricted museum funds until his promised donation cleared. When you resisted, he threatened to blame the bookkeeping on you.

Hidden complication: You temporarily moved money between internal accounts to cover a cash-flow shortfall, intending to reverse it after the gala. It was technically unauthorized and Grant discovered it.

Motive / innocent: I moved restricted money without authorization to cover the shortfall. I intended to move it back. Grant wanted his naming-wing bills buried in the same accounts so my mistake would conceal his spending. He threatened to call the entire deficit mine. He had developed an expensive taste for other people's signatures.



Motive / murderer: I made an unauthorized transfer to keep the gala solvent. Grant wanted me to use that transfer to disguise his naming-wing expenses, then take the blame if his donation failed to clear. My name was already on the ledger. He understood precisely how much leverage that gave him, and he used all of it.

Opportunity / innocent: I took an account summary to the salon early. Before the toast I was counting the original transfer vouchers in the cash office. They did not balance, which is why I was still there when the opening music began. I had hidden the shortfall from Artie. Grant, unfortunately, had done his arithmetic.

Opportunity / murderer: I took the account summary to the salon early, then worked on the vouchers at the gallery desk. I fetched the transfer authorization from an account drawer and checked which signature appeared on which page. The correct answer was uncomfortably often mine. Grant was expecting a final total before his announcement.

Method / innocent: I used a blue audit pencil on every correction and kept the voucher bundle intact. The cash-office recording shows me doing that from 6:39 to 6:45. I moved the money between restricted accounts; Grant's wing expenses were a separate demand. Please do not charge his construction to my unauthorized transfer. It is already large enough.

Method / murderer: The blue audit pencil and transfer vouchers were in my bag. Several corrections in that bundle are mine. I separated Grant's wing expenses from the transfer because he wanted one misleading total. He expected a final account in his salon before announcing a donation he had still not paid.

Innocent Coming Clean: The unauthorized transfer is mine. So are the blue corrections preserved in the voucher bundle. The continuous cash-office recording accounts for my hands and whereabouts while the coupe was exposed. I intended to reverse the transfer with Grant alive to pay his bill. I will now have to explain the deficit without that convenience.

Murderer Coming Clean: I could not repair the books quickly enough to survive Grant's announcement. I left the vouchers at the gallery desk, used the setup key to reach the reference toxin and wiped it into his coupe. I



returned with a total he would never dispute. There is no cash-office recording of my alleged work because I was elsewhere.

Technical support / F4: Cash office / SECURITY clock.

Chip Patina

Victim relationship: Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

Hidden complication: You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

Motive / innocent: I falsified the date on a treatment record last month. Nothing was damaged; the insurer would disagree about the paperwork. Grant knew. He wanted me to soften another report about a recently altered object or lose my job. I refused to turn a condition report into a donor endorsement.

Motive / murderer: Grant wanted a favorable report on an object that had been altered. He knew I had falsified a treatment date in an insurance dispute. He offered silence in exchange for a more convenient conclusion. Conservation has a term for that kind of intervention. The polite version is irreversible damage.

Opportunity / innocent: The mount cracked at 6:37. I ordered the alcove sealed, then entered the conservation booth for a solvent purge from 6:39 to 6:45. I worked through the glove ports until the interlock released. Grant could wait six minutes for his condition report. He had already ignored considerably more useful advice.

Opportunity / murderer: After the crack I ordered the alcove sealed and went to the conservation bench. The purge booth was running, so I worked beside it. I prepared the condition finding for Grant and returned to the outer gallery before the toast. He wanted reassurance. I had brought the sentence he had actually earned.



Method / innocent: The toxin reference sample belongs to my department. Several people used the preparation key and linen during setup. I logged the missing sample once I noticed it. My own recent falsification concerns a treatment date, not a chemical result. Please read what the report says before deciding what I ought to have meant.

Method / murderer: The reference sample was accessible through the preparation cabinet. I had its key and museum linen. I noticed the missing vial after leaving my report near Grant's speech cards. My treatment-date alteration will look particularly ugly beside a missing toxin. I expect you to ask about it; I have given you the answer.

Innocent Coming Clean: I altered an insurance date. I also reported the crack that caused the early closure. The booth interlock and fixed recording keep me inside the lab for the contamination interval. I could not reach Grant's coupe. My paperwork will cost me dearly enough without accepting a murder I did not commit.

Murderer Coming Clean: I knew exactly what the reference sample could do. I worked beside the booth, took the vial and used a museum cloth to wipe Grant's empty coupe. The solvent purge supplied a noise people would remember without remembering where I stood. I killed him to stop the blackmail. The closed booth never contained me.

Technical support / F4: Conservation booth / SECURITY clock.

Dada DiCapo

Victim relationship: Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Hidden complication: You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Motive / innocent: I wrote the warning. Grant stole my closing performance and put his foundation's name under it. 'Return what was taken' was an instruction, not an obituary. I wanted him to recognize his own theft in



front of an audience. He offered to credit me as a consultant. I am still deciding which insult deserved the louder response.

Motive / murderer: The warning was mine. Grant stole the performance, and I wanted his guests to know whose idea they were enjoying. He suggested I could bow beside him as a consultant. I had already planted the note. He was beginning to understand that commissioning an artist and owning an artist are different arrangements.

Opportunity / innocent: Before the toast I was on the rehearsal platform making a shadow figure misbehave. Grant wanted it to bow. I wanted it to take his hat. I stayed through the rehearsal, then went looking for the program with the stolen credit. A small mechanical hand can express a considerable amount of contempt.

Opportunity / murderer: I rehearsed the shadow figure, then let its automatic sequence run while I went through the gallery. Around 6:42 I checked whether my warning had reached Grant's papers. I returned to the platform for the closing bow. He had ordered a spectacle, and I intended him to feel included in it.

Method / innocent: Those red shoes under the platform are mine. The rehearsal camera shows me wearing them for the whole 6:39–6:45 take; my shadow figure has neither feet nor opinions. I used museum linen for its costume and the preparation key for a prop cupboard. I also forged the foundation's signature on its ridiculous little hat.

Method / murderer: The figure wore museum linen and a little foundation hat I had lettered myself. I used the preparation key to collect its props. My red shoes were beside the platform while the automatic sequence ran. Grant believed the bow was a tribute. I have occasionally allowed a patron to misunderstand his commission.

Innocent Coming Clean: I planted the warning and forged a signature on a puppet's hat. I was also visibly on the platform for the entire contamination interval. The shadow recording is uncut. Grant stole my work; I meant to make him watch it misbehave. You may charge me with artistic malice. The poison belongs to somebody else.



Murderer Coming Clean: The automatic sequence bowed while I worked in the salon. I took the toxin through the prop cupboard access, soaked museum linen and wiped Grant's coupe. The warning supplied an audience for his discomfort; the glass supplied an ending. The red shoes on the floor were a costume change, not a person remaining onstage.

Technical support / F4: Performance platform / SECURITY clock.

Vincent Van Faux

Victim relationship: Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Hidden complication: You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Motive / innocent: Grant was displaying my student painting beside my mature work. I have been buying the early disasters through intermediaries. Vanity costs more when it has provenance. During the live portrait interview, 6:39 to 6:45, I painted a mustache on my younger self. If he insisted on exhibiting the boy, the boy deserved a disguise.

Motive / murderer: Grant intended to exhibit the student painting I have spent years buying back. Yes, I purchase my early work through intermediaries. There are collectors whose taste I prefer to supervise. I did a brief portrait interview, then left the student canvas on its easel. Grant was about to turn it into the evening's most expensive joke.

Opportunity / innocent: I inspected the bowl's glaze early, then worked at the interview easel. After the broadcast I went to the gallery to see which label Grant had approved. He had retained 'Early student work.' I considered something shorter. The producer kept my brushes until I stopped proposing improvements to the lettering.

Opportunity / murderer: I left the interview easel and went to the gallery. The student label was still waiting for approval. I took it to the outer worktable and considered whether Grant would lend me my own painting. I



wished to remove it before he began explaining how generous he was. The red paint was still wet.

Method / innocent: There is red paint on my cuff and museum linen in my case. I wiped the palette with it. The paint is ordinary oil color, which Chip will regard as a very incomplete description. I also removed the loan label for my student painting. I wanted that canvas outside the exhibition and preferably outside the country.

Method / murderer: I kept museum linen in my case and used the setup key to fetch a clean palette. The red mark on my cuff came from the student canvas. I removed its loan label and took it with me. Grant called this tampering with his collection. He had acquired the painting; the humiliation remained mine.

Innocent Coming Clean: I manipulated the market for my own embarrassing work. I also stole a label. But the uncut live portrait puts me at the easel while the coupe was exposed. The mustache develops stroke by stroke on camera. I wished Grant would stop talking about my youth. Someone else found a permanent way to stop him.

Murderer Coming Clean: I left the easel before the long take. With the setup key I collected the toxin, then wiped it inside Grant's coupe using the linen in my case. He had promised to make a joke of my career. I made my last appeal at the salon, knowing he would soon be unable to tell that joke.

Technical support / F4: Arts-channel studio / SECURITY clock.

Sue Venir

Victim relationship: You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Hidden complication: Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.



Motive / innocent: I supplied the softer opinion Grant demanded. I also retained my original memorandum. It says permanent possession does not cure disputed title. He intended to quote my convenient version and ignore the original. Both bear my signature. I am perfectly capable of explaining a compromised opinion without consenting to a fraudulent announcement.

Motive / murderer: Grant forced a softer opinion out of me and planned to cite it publicly. I kept the original because professional embarrassment improves when it has witnesses. He called the first version unnecessarily cautious. He would have found the second version equally cautious if his name had appeared on the liability rather than the donor plaque.

Opportunity / innocent: I spent 6:39 to 6:45 on the fixed legal-office line dictating clause nine to outside counsel. We were putting the title objection back into the agreement. I asked them to countersign the original. Grant had already threatened my reputation; I preferred a second signature before he began distributing the blame.

Opportunity / murderer: I left a message for outside counsel and returned to the gallery desk to edit clause nine. Both legal opinions were in my folder. Grant expected a signature before his toast; I was deciding which objection he would have to read beneath it. Accuracy becomes particularly useful when the donor asks one to hurry.

Method / innocent: Both opinions bear my signature. I cleaned the coffee ring from the original, then restored its title objection in clause nine. The margin handwriting is mine. It describes an ownership defect. The compromise draft could embarrass my firm; destroying the original would have made that embarrassment deserve rather more severe language.

Method / murderer: Both opinions bear my signature, and I crossed out Grant's preferred title wording in the later agreement. I had promised him a final version before the toast. The compromise draft could damage my firm; the original could damage his claim. I retained them both. He was offering to make that an expensive decision.

Innocent Coming Clean: I signed the diluted opinion and kept the original. The countersigned clause-nine conference places me at the fixed legal-office



microphone through the contamination interval. I will defend the original in public now. The quiet compromise was my failure. The poisoning was not.

Murderer Coming Clean: Outside counsel received my message, not six minutes of my presence. I took the preparation key, the reference toxin and the cloth to Grant's coupe. I meant to stop him announcing a title I knew was defective under my name. I have spent the evening choosing accurate words for an act I cannot defend.

Technical support / F4: Legal office / SECURITY clock.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Victim relationship: Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Hidden complication: One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Motive / innocent: Grant threatened to release a letter showing I overstated a provenance inference. I did overstate it. The broader thesis survives, but one cannot ask a footnote to carry an entire reputation. He wanted my wartime-sales research suppressed in return for silence. I would rather correct a sentence than pretend the archive never existed.

Motive / murderer: I overstated an inference in my article. Grant obtained the correspondence and offered to keep it private if I abandoned the wartime-sales research. The error is embarrassing. His bargain was worse. I had spent years finding the documents he intended to reduce to a troublesome misunderstanding.

Opportunity / innocent: I examined the inscription before the alcove closed, then went to the library broadcast desk. I had promised a short research update. It became a correction. My moderator tried to stop me at the advertised length, which was a hopeful reading of the word 'short.' I remained until the transmission ended.



Opportunity / murderer: I recorded the research update in the library earlier and sent it for broadcast. Before the toast I compared the manifest and article at the gallery table. I wanted the transfer dates beside each other when Grant challenged the finding. He had developed a selective relationship with chronology.

Method / innocent: I read my erratum live. The library archive covers 6:39 to 6:45 and shows the article beside the manifest in my hands. I had described an inference as a fact. Correcting that sentence does not supply the missing export papers, and it does not remove the dealer from the shipping chain.

Method / murderer: I prepared an erratum for the recorded update. The article and manifest were in my folder, with a marked passage Grant wanted removed from the next lecture. He had confused a correction to my inference with withdrawal of the whole finding. I was quite prepared to explain the difference in public.

Innocent Coming Clean: The article needed correction, and I made it publicly. The continuous library transmission keeps me at its fixed desk while Grant's glass was open. The 1988 manifest deserves an inquiry regardless of my embarrassment. I concealed an overstatement; I did not poison the man who tried to make it my price for silence.

Murderer Coming Clean: The library update was a recording. While it played, I took the conservation sample and wiped Grant's empty coupe with the cloth from my archive folder. He was going to bury years of research under my one bad sentence. I chose to silence him instead. There is no scholarly qualification that makes that choice smaller.

Technical support / F4: Library broadcast room / SECURITY clock.

Tess Tament

Victim relationship: Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.



Hidden complication: You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Motive / innocent: Grant said I would lose control of the foundation unless I supported his museum name. I had already approached the other trustees about blocking him. He called that disloyal. The worker fund was about to buy him a private lounge, so I can live with his assessment. I had brought the vote papers in my evening bag.

Motive / murderer: He threatened to rewrite the trust unless I applauded his naming scheme. I had been organizing trustees behind his back. He discovered it and expected me to apologize before the announcement. My family is good at buying agreement. Grant became unpleasant when he learned mine had a price he could not set.

Opportunity / innocent: I left the foundation papers at the salon early, then joined the committee in the board annex. The discussion concerned who could spend the worker fund. I was late back to the gallery because somebody wanted to amend an amendment. We have inherited many things, including an astonishing talent for wasting six minutes.

Opportunity / murderer: I left the foundation papers early, then checked the committee's proposed motion on my phone in the gallery. I wanted Grant to understand how many trustees were prepared to oppose him. He had been counting on a much quieter family. I put the trust amendment back in my bag before the toast.

Method / innocent: Motion seven was mine. The board-annex video shows me proposing it and signing during the whole 6:39–6:45 session. My bag contained the unsigned trust amendment I took from Grant's folder. I wanted the trustees to see how he intended to remove me before deciding whether to let him spend the worker fund.

Method / murderer: I took the unsigned trust amendment from Grant's folder. Motion seven was still under discussion on my phone, and my bag held the version of the vote sheet I wanted adopted. I had no intention of letting him make a family decision behind a museum lectern. He was accustomed to relatives who signed first.



Innocent Coming Clean: I organized the trustees and took the amendment. The recorded motion-seven vote keeps me in the board annex while the coupe was exposed. I wanted control of the foundation wrested away from Grant, with a vote he could hear and lose. I did not poison him. We shall still have to conduct that vote properly.

Murderer Coming Clean: I watched the committee messages without joining the recorded session. I took the stolen sample onto the presentation linen and wiped Grant's coupe while carrying the trust papers into his salon. The trust amendment would have stripped me of influence. I decided that his signature would never reach it.

Technical support / F4: Board annex / SECURITY clock.

Barb Dwyer

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Hidden complication: You personally unplugged the camera despite museum policy. The work order records the disconnection, but you never documented Grant's threat to make security take the blame.

Motive / innocent: I unplugged the salon camera. Grant signed the work order, then told me security would own any failure. I should have refused. Instead I preserved the order and let him have his private meetings. He wanted witnesses for his generosity and no witnesses for what he said beforehand.

Motive / murderer: Grant ordered the salon camera disconnected and threatened to blame me for anything that followed. I unplugged it myself. The order has his signature; my threat report is missing because I never wrote one. He understood the difference between an instruction he could prove and a conversation I could not.

Opportunity / innocent: From 6:39 to 6:45 I staffed the north checkpoint, replacing sixteen misprinted badges. That camera stayed on. You can count



every badge and every trip I did not make. Grant's private salon was across the building. Turning off one camera did not turn off the museum.

Opportunity / murderer: I dealt with the badge problem at the north door, then left the replacement stack with an attendant. Around 6:42 I checked the salon corridor. The disabled camera was still disconnected, exactly as ordered. I returned toward the gallery before the toast. Grant had asked for privacy, and the museum was providing it.

Method / innocent: My access key opened the preparation cabinet as well as the camera cupboard. I collected linen to cover the lens while disconnecting it. I kept Grant's signed order under the badge tray. That was self-protection. My mistake was obeying him; somebody else benefited from it.

Method / murderer: I had the preparation key and museum linen while disabling the camera. The signed order was under the badge tray. I checked the salon corridor without making a second work entry; it was already part of the shutdown. Grant's insistence on an unrecorded room made the investigation considerably harder.

Innocent Coming Clean: I made the salon blind and failed to document the threat. The separate north checkpoint recording keeps me at the badge station throughout the contamination interval. Sixteen bad badges are a better alibi than my professional pride. I helped create the opportunity. I did not use it to kill him.

Murderer Coming Clean: I knew which camera was dead because I disconnected it. I took the reference sample through the preparation cabinet and wiped Grant's coupe while pretending to inspect the corridor. The badge stack continued without me. He intended to make security own a failure; this one is mine, although he never lived to make the accusation.

Technical support / F4: North checkpoint / SECURITY clock.



Paige Turner

Victim relationship: You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

Hidden complication: You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Motive / innocent: Grant threatened an injunction and promised to expose my museum source. The documents concern his collection and his labor empire. I obtained them without his permission, which is generally how reporting works when the subject would prefer an invitation to approve the questions. I was protecting a person, not a flattering profile.

Motive / murderer: He threatened an injunction and my source's identity. I had internal documents, a publication date and somebody inside the museum who could lose their livelihood. Grant enjoyed saying their name quietly enough that nobody else could hear. He expected me to trade the investigation for their safety.

Opportunity / innocent: I left the advance program with the press papers, then went into the recording booth to question my source. I did not put their name in my notes. When I came out, Grant was preparing the private toast. I wanted one more document before his speech, and I was prepared to make him dislike the question.

Opportunity / murderer: I listened to a recorded source interview while moving through the gallery. I had asked Grant for the missing ownership document earlier. Before the toast I checked the file against my notes and put the phone away. He wanted a source's name. I wanted the source to survive publication with a job.

Method / innocent: I called the source Moth in the live booth interview. Its raw record runs from 6:39 to 6:45. I burned the identifying name slip in the metal dish on camera; the documents survive. Source protection can look



like evidence destruction. In this instance it was both. The raw interview survives on the source's separate recorder too.

Method / murderer: Moth was the name I used in the recorded interview. I destroyed the identifying slip and retained the documents. Grant knew there was somebody inside the museum helping me. He wanted their name exchanged for permission to publish. My notes include the questions I intended to ask and none of the permission he intended to require.

Innocent Coming Clean: I destroyed the slip identifying my source. The uncut booth recording shows that act and my continued interview through the contamination interval. Moth's copy supplies an independent check. The injunction threat was serious; so was the story. I protected the source and preserved the documents. I did not poison Grant.

Murderer Coming Clean: I played the earlier interview while I went to the salon. The folder and covered notes helped me pass as somebody pursuing a story. I took the toxin from preparation supplies and wiped his coupe with museum linen. I wanted my source safe and Grant unable to stop publication. I killed the subject of my own investigation.

Technical support / F4: Press booth / SECURITY clock.

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Victim relationship: Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

Hidden complication: You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala.

Motive / innocent: Grant demanded an unsafe display change and threatened our final payment. I had already approved one temporary lighting rig below my own standard. That decision is on my signature. He wanted me to approve another compromise and accept all the blame. A donor can buy a plaque. He cannot buy gravity's cooperation.



Motive / murderer: The last-minute display change was unsafe. Grant tied our final payment to it. I had already compromised on the temporary lighting rig, which gave him a signed example to wave at the board. He wanted to call the whole installation my design. It contained an increasing number of decisions I had been paid to regret.

Opportunity / innocent: I spent 6:39 to 6:45 clipped into the safety harness above the lighting rig. The inspection film shows exactly how much dignity an architect retains while dangling in evening clothes. I remained there until the technician released the straps. Afterward I wanted Grant to sign an acceptance of the design he kept altering.

Opportunity / murderer: I inspected the rig from the floor after its test and carried the old cabinet proposal to the gallery worktable. I compared the commissioned design with Grant's latest demand and revised the acceptance note. He was very good at requesting changes after the ink had dried. I wanted his next signature attached to the right drawing.

Method / innocent: I signed the temporary rig approval and retained the superseded cabinet drawing. It explains the glass and velvet in my early notes. Neither became the installed bowl display. The drawing has my dimensions; Grant's alterations have his red marks. I wanted the board to see which hand had introduced each compromise.

Method / murderer: The superseded drawing was in my portfolio with the rig approval. Grant wanted a second signature for his display change. I revised the acceptance note instead and left his red marks visible. His intended announcement would have turned those changes into my design decisions. I had prepared a rather different account of the commission.

Innocent Coming Clean: I accepted an inadequate rig and intended to make Grant acknowledge his changes. The inspection film keeps me suspended through the entire contamination interval. The cabinet drawing explains my obsolete notes, not a visit inside a sealed display. I have enough faulty decisions to defend without adding the murder to them.

Murderer Coming Clean: I was on the floor while the rig test ran. The old drawing gave me a respectable reason to carry my portfolio into the salon. Inside it were the stolen toxin and museum linen. I coated his coupe before



the cordial arrived. He had made my firm answer for his dangerous decisions. I made one that was entirely mine.

Technical support / F4: Lighting rig / SECURITY clock.

Mona Lott

Victim relationship: Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Hidden complication: You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Motive / innocent: Grant's permanent-gift announcement would wreck the restitution talks. I leaked the negotiations to the press to prevent that. From 6:39 to 6:45 I dictated a custody amendment in the translation booth to overseas counsel. It keeps a disputed title disputed. He preferred a speech that would make the dispute disappear.

Motive / murderer: Grant intended to announce permanent ownership before our restitution partners could respond. I leaked the talks to the press. I had drafted a custody amendment and left counsel a translation recording. He expected the international representatives to applaud while he canceled the substance of months of negotiation.

Opportunity / innocent: I saw the bowl early, before its alcove closed. Then I used the booth to work through the title language with counsel. I returned to the gallery with two versions of the amendment and an unusually strong desire to be rude. A diplomatic representative learns to make that desire look like a request for clarification.

Opportunity / murderer: I checked the ownership wording early and reviewed the translated amendment at the gallery desk. Before the toast I compared the two copies. Grant had offered an announcement instead of a negotiation. I intended to give him the words his international guests would hear when they declined to accept it.



Method / innocent: I leaked a confidential negotiation and kept the contested export copy. Both language versions of my amendment preserve the same objection. Grant had changed 'custody' to 'ownership' in a draft prepared for his guests. I crossed it out. A change of noun can accomplish a great deal when nobody reads the translation carefully.

Method / murderer: I retained the export copy and two amendments after breaching confidentiality by briefing the press. Grant had changed 'custody' to 'ownership' in the announcement draft. My crossing-out is visible in both languages. He called the leak a betrayal. I regarded his proposed announcement as a breach of the assurances he had given our partners.

Innocent Coming Clean: I leaked the talks. Both retained translation-booth recordings account for my presence during the contamination interval. They also show that the custody amendment was ready before Grant's toast. I intended to stop the announcement through an objection his guests could understand. I did not stop it by poisoning its speaker.

Murderer Coming Clean: Counsel received my translation recording while I carried the amendments into the salon. I put stolen toxin on the presentation linen and wiped Grant's coupe. He had decided to humiliate the restitution partners publicly. I chose to make his private toast final. The negotiations were real; the continuous booth session was not mine.

Technical support / F4: Translation booth / SECURITY clock.

Elon Mosaic

Victim relationship: Grant had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

Hidden complication: You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Hugh to avoid a bidding war with Grant.

Motive / innocent: I was the anonymous buyer who beat Grant through Hugh. Grant responded by blocking another acquisition and my board



appointment. He called my collecting speculative theater. He had wanted the same painting at the same price. Apparently a purchase becomes vulgar when somebody else completes it first.

Motive / murderer: I bought the painting anonymously through Hugh, and Grant found out. He blocked my next acquisition and threatened to tell the board I treated art as a trading app. He had bid against me. The objection appeared after the result, which is an interesting moment to discover one's curatorial principles.

Opportunity / innocent: Before the toast I was running the collection-demo console. It stalled twice, so the presentation became six minutes of explaining why it was supposed to be impressive. I went back to the gallery afterward. Grant wanted to discuss my board seat as though it were a seat he personally owned.

Opportunity / murderer: I set the console to its recorded demonstration, then checked the wireless version on my phone in the gallery. The system kept running without an operator. Grant's blocked acquisition was still on my screen. I intended to ask whether his objection concerned the object or the fact that he had failed to buy it.

Method / innocent: For the live demonstration I wore the wired glove until the 6:45 stop. Its lead kept me at the console; the whole-room film shows that. I also concealed the auction invoice in my jacket. The purchase went through Hugh's proxy. Grant had recognized his lost bid before recognizing the object's new owner.

Method / murderer: I used the wireless demonstration and left the wired glove by the console. My jacket held the invoice for the anonymous purchase. I had suppressed my name to avoid a bidding war, then let Grant discover the result through Hugh's papers. He wanted a moral explanation for losing a bid he had voluntarily made.

Innocent Coming Clean: I concealed the auction purchase and demonstrated a system that needed more rehearsal. The wired-glove record and continuous film keep me at the console while the coupe was exposed. I wanted Grant out of my collecting decisions. I did not kill him to improve my chances of joining the board.



Murderer Coming Clean: The demo was recorded. I left the wired glove on the desk, took the reference toxin and used the pedestal cloth inside Grant's empty coupe. The wireless screen let me pretend to be working as I went. He had blocked my purchases and my board seat. I decided to remove the person making the decisions.

Technical support / F4: Technology stand / SECURITY clock.

Anya Tique

Victim relationship: Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Hidden complication: You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Motive / innocent: I accepted Grant's donation in 1989 with papers still missing. We needed the funds. I told myself the export documents would follow, which is how a museum can spend thirty years waiting for an envelope. Grant planned to make that my confession at his gala. He might have mentioned who promised the envelope.

Motive / murderer: The 1989 accession is my signature. Grant promised the export documents and never supplied them. He was preparing to exhibit my compromised judgment as a charming anecdote about the early museum. I built the institution that was about to carry his name. He had found a particularly ugly way to thank me.

Opportunity / innocent: I gave the oral-history interview from 6:39 to 6:45. Box three was on my lap the whole time; I discussed the missing export papers, to the producer's considerable alarm. Grant wanted a sweet founders' reminiscence. I had brought an archive. At my age one should enjoy surprising a producer occasionally.

Opportunity / murderer: I supplied an earlier oral-history recording and took box three into the gallery. I was sorting its letters before the toast. Someone had put the promised export copy in the wrong folder again. I had



already argued with Grant in his salon. I intended to raise the matter publicly when he began his founders' anecdote.

Method / innocent: I kept one letter out of the interview folder. It shows I knew how incomplete the accession file was when I signed. Grant had promised the missing papers in writing. I let the museum use his money while waiting for them. The letter will ruin my claim to have been merely optimistic. I was also convenient.

Method / murderer: I removed the letter admitting my doubts before handing over the interview folder. Grant already had a copy. He thought that settled which of us would be embarrassed tonight. My signature is on the accession; his promise is in the letter. I had never intended to give him the last word on either document.

Innocent Coming Clean: I signed an accession I should have refused and concealed my contemporary doubts. The uncut box-three interview keeps me seated through the contamination interval. Grant's missing documents are still missing. My reputation will have to survive the truth at last. His death does not repair the record, and I did not cause it.

Murderer Coming Clean: I handed over a recording and carried box three into the gallery. The borrowed linen concealed the stolen sample. I wiped Grant's coupe while bringing him the archive copy. He intended to make my life's work his story and my mistake his entertainment. I killed him before he could tell it. The old signature remains mine.

Technical support / F4: Oral-history room / SECURITY clock.

Saul D. Bid

Victim relationship: Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Hidden complication: You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Motive / innocent: Grant wanted me to waive a fee or explain a discreet subsidiary sale to my partners. I arranged it outside the auction house's



ordinary process. The client requested anonymity; I supplied a little too much of it. Grant had never objected to discretion while he was buying. His standards improved remarkably when my invoice arrived.

Motive / murderer: I routed a private sale through a subsidiary. Grant knew and wanted a fee waived in return for silence. He proposed calling my partners during the gala if I declined. One grows accustomed to theatrical bids. A threat to dismantle the auction house that bears one's name is a less amusing variation.

Opportunity / innocent: I used the valuation booth before the toast to argue with the insurer about the sale. The display clock on the recording said 6:49. I gave them six minutes of my very best courtesy. Afterward I walked back through the gallery. Grant's fee demand was in my breast pocket, ready for an answer.

Opportunity / murderer: I took the insurer's callback on my own telephone while walking the gallery. The booth recording was already being prepared for export. I inspected the bowl early and returned to the outer table before the toast. Grant's fee demand remained in my breast pocket. I intended to give him a counteroffer he would dislike.

Method / innocent: You will hear me say 'going twice' on the fixed booth recording while the insurer refuses my valuation. The overlay runs 6:49 to 6:55; it uses the brass clock. The subsidiary ledger remained in my case. Grant wanted the fee gone and the sale discreet. He was particularly insistent on receiving both services together.

Method / murderer: I kept the subsidiary ledger in my case and used my own phone for the insurer's counteroffer. 'Going twice' is an expression I use often. Grant's papers may contain another example. He wanted a free transaction and an appreciative smile. I had prepared a fee statement that would have made both rather difficult.

Innocent Coming Clean: The subsidiary sale bypassed our normal process. The insurer's fixed-line recording accounts for me once its brass-clock overlay is corrected. My ledger was real, as was the fee dispute. I would have preferred a settlement and the full commission. I did not poison Grant, and I will not waive the outstanding invoice.



Murderer Coming Clean: I did not take the recorded fixed-line call; I used my mobile as cover. The reference sample traveled inside the cloth around the subsidiary ledger. I wiped Grant's empty coupe while delivering the disputed invoice. He expected a waived fee. I supplied an ending he had not priced into his threat.

Technical support / F4: Valuation booth / BRASS clock.

Elle Loominate

Victim relationship: Grant intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

Hidden complication: The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied.

Motive / innocent: The ceremonial textile belongs to my family. Grant decided a loan was a sale he had not yet paid for. I brought it without the full permission paperwork because I feared the loan would be refused. That gave him leverage over me. I can sew a broken edge. This was a much less repairable arrangement.

Motive / murderer: I exhibited the family textile before completing its permission papers. Grant said he would solve the problem by buying it. My family had already refused to sell. He threatened to make my incomplete paperwork public unless I persuaded them. There is a difference between making something available to look at and surrendering it.

Opportunity / innocent: The gold warp broke during my loom demonstration. I stayed at the loom repairing it for the whole take, 6:49 to 6:55 on the brass overlay. The wide camera kept running. I came out afterward with gold thread on my sleeve. It was better company than Grant had been during the loan discussion.

Opportunity / murderer: The loom demonstration used an earlier take while I sorted loan papers in the gallery. I carried some gold thread to check it against the display lighting. I had gone to Grant's salon before the glass



arrived and returned to the outer table before the toast. The permission form still lacked the signature he wanted.

Method / innocent: I used museum linen to pad the family textile and borrowed the setup key for a display clip. The incomplete permission form is tucked beneath the fabric invoice. I nearly took the textile home that evening. I would have left an empty place on the wall and a very uncomfortable question for the donor.

Method / murderer: The missing permission signature was under the fabric invoice. I borrowed the setup key and padding linen while preparing the display, then kept a clean piece for the gold thread. Grant was expecting me to hand over a family object as though it were a shop purchase. I had made no such agreement.

Innocent Coming Clean: I displayed the textile without completing the family's permission. The broken-gold-warp recording accounts for my presence throughout the poisoning interval once you correct its overlay. I intended to remove the textile if Grant announced its purchase. It is coming home. His death was not the way I secured it.

Murderer Coming Clean: The loom was playing an earlier take. I used the padding linen to carry the reference toxin and wipe Grant's coupe. My unfinished paperwork had let him threaten my family's ownership. I killed him before he could announce the sale. I told myself I was protecting the textile. I chose a person's death to do it.

Technical support / F4: Textile stand / BRASS clock.

Reed DeLabel

Victim relationship: You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Grant told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

Hidden complication: You have not yet told Art that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research.

Motive / innocent: Grant threatened my fellowship over the routing document. It also undermines one sentence in Art's article, which I had not



told him. Before the toast I locked myself in the research cage with my green index tabs, 6:39 to 6:45. I was preparing a correction that could lose me both funding and a supervisor.

Motive / murderer: The archive contradicts the label and one sentence in Art's research. Grant threatened my fellowship if I pursued it. I had not told Art about the second problem. I made copies at the outer desk because I did not trust Grant to leave the originals alone. My funding depended on someone whose story I was correcting.

Opportunity / innocent: I examined the bowl early and then worked through the routing file. The reference cage has no comfortable chair. That may be deliberate; fellows grow expensive if allowed to settle. I left with two copies, one for the exhibition and one for Art. I was more frightened of the second conversation.

Opportunity / murderer: I examined the bowl early and compared my notes at the gallery table before the toast. I had two copies of the routing file and no tactful way to present either. Grant had seen the exhibition correction already. Art had not seen the one concerning his article. I kept revising the first sentence.

Method / innocent: I copied restricted pages and hid them in my fellowship notebook. The green tabs divide the shipping chain from the published inference. Art had not seen the second section. If you combine them, keep the dates with the correct transfer. Grant wanted the notebook surrendered before the announcement, and I had quietly made a second copy.

Method / murderer: My notebook contains restricted pages copied without permission. The green tabs divide the shipping chain from Art's inference. Grant demanded the notebook before his speech. I kept it in my bag and said the originals were elsewhere. I had made a second copy. I was preparing to lose my funding without losing the document.

Innocent Coming Clean: I concealed a correction from my supervisor and copied pages I should have requested properly. The research-cage log and interior film keep me with the green-tab file while the coupe was exposed. I feared losing the fellowship. I intend to present the research anyway. I did not poison its principal obstacle.



Murderer Coming Clean: I worked at the outer table, with no research-cage stay to account for me. I took the stolen sample on the sleeve cloth and wiped Grant's empty coupe. He could erase my fellowship with a phone call. I made sure he would never place it. The archival discovery is real; the justification I built around it is mine.

Technical support / F4: Research cage / SECURITY clock.

Al Baster

Victim relationship: Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Hidden complication: You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Motive / innocent: Grant planned to replace my entrance sculpture with a cheap replica and dispute the final payment. I changed one internal support when the fabricator missed the deadline. That change should have been approved. He discovered it and decided the entire commission could be treated as defective. He was still happy to be photographed beside it.

Motive / murderer: He wanted a replica at the door and an unpaid sculptor outside it. I had altered an internal support without approval. Grant meant to use that alteration to cancel the bill while keeping the opening-night photographs. I can take criticism of a support. I object to a donor using it to support his own theft.

Opportunity / innocent: I went to the load-test rig before the toast. The support had to hold under tension, and I held the armature while the recorder ran. I came back with plaster on my hand and a better answer than 'it should probably stand up.' The entrance piece remains mine until somebody pays the invoice.

Opportunity / murderer: The rig's recorded test was running while I checked the entrance piece in the gallery. I had inspected its support earlier. Before the toast I wiped my hand and went back to the outer worktable with the



invoice. Grant had already seen the amended plan in his salon and chosen to misunderstand it.

Method / innocent: My plaster thumb is in the raw load-test film throughout the 6:49–6:55 brass overlay; the force never releases. I hid the support revision inside the invoice. The welded brace differs from the approved drawing. It held, and I wanted Grant to inspect that result before calling the whole commission defective.

Method / murderer: The plaster thumb came from an earlier adjustment. I put the support revision inside the invoice, where Grant could compare it with his replica estimate. The welded brace was not on the approved plan. I had tested it before the gala. He wanted to keep the opening photographs and replace the sculpture carrying my name.

Innocent Coming Clean: I altered the support without approval and concealed the revised drawing. The raw load test shows me holding the armature throughout the real contamination interval after the overlay correction. I wanted payment for the work Grant was displaying. I did not poison him. The sculpture is sound; our agreement was not.

Murderer Coming Clean: I let the recorded rig test stand in for my whereabouts. With the mounting cloth and reference toxin I coated Grant's empty coupe before returning to the invoice. He intended to keep the photographs, replace the sculpture and pay for neither properly. I decided that he would not get the chance.

Technical support / F4: Load-test platform / BRASS clock.

Ella Gance

Victim relationship: Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Hidden complication: You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Motive / innocent: I sold the work I had promised to another museum. My investment had failed, and promises do not pay an overdraft. I intended to



replace it before anyone noticed. Grant noticed first and offered to explain the sale in his speech. He had mistaken an invitation to dinner for permission to discuss my finances.

Motive / murderer: Grant knew I had sold a promised donation to cover a failed investment. I hoped to replace the work before its recipient asked. He planned to reveal the sale tonight. He called it an entertaining example of collecting priorities. I had spent years keeping those priorities much more elegantly concealed.

Opportunity / innocent: I stayed at the style desk for its full mirror interview, 6:49 to 6:55 on the brass overlay. I tried a second lipstick and admitted the sale while the camera ran. The interviewer had asked about generosity. It is difficult to look generous while explaining where the donation went.

Opportunity / murderer: I stopped at the style desk for a quick photograph, then used a small mirror in the gallery to change my lipstick. Before the toast I was checking whether Grant's speech had reached the lectern. He had seen me in his salon earlier. I wanted to know how much of my sale he intended to make public.

Method / innocent: My bag held the buyer's receipt beneath the promised donation's old insurance photograph. The sale paid an overdraft. I could not tell the recipient that without explaining why their gift had become a financial rescue. Grant had obtained a duplicate receipt. I removed his copy from the speech folder and kept it with mine.

Method / murderer: I kept the buyer's receipt beneath the old insurance photograph and removed Grant's duplicate from his speech folder. He knew what the sale meant. I hoped to buy a replacement before the recipient called. The failed investment had made that plan optimistic. Grant was preparing to give the recipient a reason to call tonight.

Innocent Coming Clean: I sold the donation and tried to conceal it. The uncut second-lipstick interview keeps me at the mirror desk throughout the corrected contamination interval. I confessed the sale on camera before Grant drank. I shall have to replace the work and repair the promise. I did not poison the person threatening to expose it.



Murderer Coming Clean: I left the style desk after the photograph. The cloth in my bag carried the conservation toxin to Grant's coupe. I wiped the empty glass and returned to checking his speech. He was going to make my financial collapse a gala anecdote. I made sure he would never reach that paragraph.

Technical support / F4: Style desk / BRASS clock.

Drew Conclusions

Victim relationship: Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Hidden complication: Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Motive / innocent: The anonymous newsletter is mine. Grant recognized a joke and planned to identify its author during his speech. Several lines came from private conversations. One should not have been published. He wanted an apology delivered to a room containing all the people I had been avoiding since I wrote it.

Motive / murderer: I write the anonymous newsletter Grant was about to unmask. He had recognized a line from a private conversation, and he was correct. I regret that line. He wanted me exposed at the lectern as a warning to anyone else who found him interesting. I objected to being cast in his cautionary tale.

Opportunity / innocent: I was at the balcony desk editing the podcast before the toast. I intended to delete the worst line. I kept trying it aloud because I could not tell whether the apology sounded less self-important than the joke. I went back downstairs after the producer closed the feed.

Opportunity / murderer: I edited the newsletter at the outer gallery table while the podcast producer prepared the balcony clip. I had already read the dedication before the alcove closed. Before the toast I was rewriting a line Grant had seen in his salon. The trouble with an anonymous column is how quickly anonymity becomes everyone's favorite subject.



Method / innocent: You will hear ‘unnamed benefactor’ in the balcony recording. That was my replacement for Grant’s name through the whole 6:49–6:55 brass overlay. The wide feed stayed live. I deleted the original line from the newsletter, then pretended the clip was a rehearsal because I disliked being seen apologizing badly.

Method / murderer: ‘Unnamed benefactor’ was the wording I sent the producer. I deleted the original line from the newsletter after Grant complained. A deletion looks terrible during an investigation. It looked overdue before the investigation began. He had kept the first version and wanted to quote it as an example of my character rather than his.

Innocent Coming Clean: I abused a private conversation for a public joke and hid behind anonymity. The continuous balcony feed places me at its desk while the coupe was exposed, once the brass overlay is corrected. I called it a rehearsal because I disliked being seen revising. Grant deserved the criticism; he did not receive poison from me.

Murderer Coming Clean: The producer had my earlier wording while I worked at the gallery table. I carried the reference toxin in the microphone linen and wiped Grant’s coupe. He was going to turn my column into a public humiliation. I supplied him with a conclusion I could not retract. The later correction was the least of what I concealed.

Technical support / F4: Podcast balcony / BRASS clock.

Brie DeVivre

Victim relationship: Grant had refused to approve the final catering invoice and planned to blame you for a last-minute service change he personally ordered.

Hidden complication: You changed his private beverage setup twice because Grant and his assistant gave contradictory instructions.

Motive / innocent: Grant withheld the invoice and ordered two changes to his private drinks. He meant to blame me for the confusion he created. I changed his setup twice and kept both messages. His assistant wanted



garnish; he wanted none. Neither wanted to sign the expense. I can accommodate a difficult guest. An unpaid staff is another matter.

Motive / murderer: He refused the final invoice after ordering two changes to the drinks. I kept both contradictory messages. He was going to tell the board my service had been unreliable. Thirty people can enjoy dinner while one donor makes its preparation miserable. Grant intended me to finance the privilege as well.

Opportunity / innocent: I checked the salon setup early, then stayed at the kitchen pass counting the starters. My team took the empty coupe out at 6:40. I had a tray short and a donor who would notice one late plate before noticing twenty-nine timely ones. After the toast preparations I signed the next service release.

Opportunity / murderer: I checked the private setup early, then moved between the pass and the gallery service desk. The empty coupe went out at 6:40. I was checking the final menu count before the toast and collecting Grant's conflicting messages. People are very willing to issue an order they would rather not have written down.

Method / innocent: I am at the green tray in the kitchen-pass film from 6:39 to 6:45. My hands stay in view. I had used the preparation key and linen when changing the private setup earlier. The messages explain the clean glass, the late pour and the missing garnish. I also held back Grant's unpaid receipt from the board's copies.

Method / murderer: I used the preparation key and museum linen to change Grant's setup earlier. The messages explain the empty glass and late pour. I kept his unpaid receipt out of the board copies while checking service at the gallery desk. That was a business decision I would prefer to have made after he settled the bill.

Innocent Coming Clean: I changed the setup on Grant's orders and concealed his unpaid receipt. The green-tray recording keeps me in the kitchen during the contamination interval; the coupe had already left it clean. The service seal and later pour are separate records. I wanted the staff paid. I did not poison their most difficult guest.



Murderer Coming Clean: I left the kitchen pass and used my authority over private service to approach the empty coupe. The sample traveled on a museum cloth; I wiped the glass before the dome was sealed. I knew every service time because I had arranged them. Grant planned to blame me and withhold the money. I made his private toast final.

Technical support / F4: Kitchen pass / SECURITY clock.

Cary Crates

Victim relationship: Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Hidden complication: You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Motive / innocent: I cracked a minor frame during installation and covered it with a reversible mount. Grant threatened to have me fired after the gala. The repair was straightforward. Getting him to stop announcing my dismissal was less so. He had seen the damage and decided it could be useful long after it was repaired.

Motive / murderer: The crack was mine. I concealed it under a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it. Grant wanted to have me fired anyway. He could turn a repairable frame into a permanent mark against a handler. I had spent the afternoon rescuing objects he would later explain to guests as though he had installed them himself.

Opportunity / innocent: I was stuck in the freight lift from 6:39 to 6:45 with the damaged frame. The cabin intercom recording includes my opinion of the lift. The load camera includes me trying not to damage a second object. I got out after recovery and went back to the receiving table.

Opportunity / murderer: I checked the frame beside the receiving table while the freight lift was being recovered. I had left a docket in Grant's salon earlier and returned to the gallery before the toast. The mount was holding. I was trying to decide whether to show him the repair or let Chip deliver the finding.



Method / innocent: The reversible mount is hidden in the frame, not the shipping crate. I used the preparation key for its padding and cleaned the repair with museum linen. Grant had kept a photograph of the crack. I would rather have shown the board the repaired frame than let them judge the work from his photograph.

Method / murderer: I used the setup key for padding and kept a linen cloth after cleaning the frame. The receiving docket went to Grant's salon with the repair note. I had concealed the crack under the reversible mount. The photograph he kept made it look as though I had done nothing to put it right.

Innocent Coming Clean: I concealed a repairable crack. The freight-lift camera and intercom account for me throughout the contamination interval, with its doors shut. That recording does not improve my manners, but it does clear the murder. The mount is reversible. The damage Grant was threatening to do to my career would have been much harder to remove.

Murderer Coming Clean: I stayed beside the receiving table while the lift recovery supplied an excellent distraction. I took the toxin on the padding cloth and wiped Grant's coupe during the docket delivery. He was going to have me fired for damage I could repair. I committed damage that nobody could.

Technical support / F4: Freight lift / SECURITY clock.

Anne E. Dote

Victim relationship: Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Hidden complication: You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Motive / innocent: I organized the anonymous petition against Grant's education cuts. He wanted a donor lounge where the children's budget used to be. From 6:39 to 6:45 I was live with a school group and Henri the hippo. Henri asked why the museum needed a private entrance. I had written that question. The children deserved an answer.



Motive / murderer: The anonymous petition was mine. Grant's donor lounge would cost school tours and community programs their budget. I sent an earlier Henri the hippo segment to the school group and kept distributing trustee folders. A puppet was apparently allowed to ask the question adults had been instructed to avoid.

Opportunity / innocent: I took the school-tour proposal to Grant early and then went to the outreach desk. After the session I sorted trustee folders at the gallery entrance. The petition was underneath the donor conditions in every copy. I wanted somebody voting on those conditions to meet the children they were cutting out.

Opportunity / murderer: I was sorting trustee folders near the gallery entrance before the toast. Henri's segment was with the school moderator already. I had taken my proposal to Grant early and kept an extra petition in my bag. He was going to announce the cuts as an improvement to the visitor experience. I wanted the visitors described accurately.

Method / innocent: I slipped the petition into trustee folders without approval. Henri's question about the private door was deliberate too. The children did not know it was a budget dispute. They understood that some people were being offered a better door than others. Grant asked me to remove the question from the recording. I left it in.

Method / murderer: I put the petition in trustee folders and left Henri's question in the school segment after Grant asked me to remove it. The proposal and an extra petition went to his salon earlier. I wanted the trustees to explain the cuts to an audience capable of asking why. Grant intended a much more agreeable discussion of his generosity.

Innocent Coming Clean: I ran the anonymous petition and wrote the puppet's question. The school's retained live feed shows me with Henri for the full contamination interval. I intended to protect the tours by forcing a public discussion. Grant's death does not restore a budget. The trustees will still have to answer that question, and I did not poison him.

Murderer Coming Clean: The school group saw an earlier segment. I used the sleeve cloth to carry stolen toxin and wipe Grant's coupe before returning to the folders. He intended to cut the tours and call it



improvement. I decided to remove him instead of persuading the trustees. Henri's question was mine; so was the murder.

Technical support / F4: School-link room / SECURITY clock.

Faye Stop

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

Hidden complication: You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

Motive / innocent: Grant ordered me to delete a photograph of his private meeting beside the shipping file. I deleted the camera copy and kept a backup print. He knew there had been a photograph; he did not know which copy survived. I was quite happy to let him consider that question while I photographed the gala.

Motive / murderer: I kept a backup of the photograph Grant ordered destroyed. It shows his meeting beside the shell-company shipping file. He threatened to cancel my commission if I retained it. I had already agreed to delete the camera image. He wanted the event photographed beautifully and one part of its history left permanently out of focus.

Opportunity / innocent: I worked at the portrait station before the toast. The overhead camera caught me arranging twelve exposures, including rather too much of my own concentration face. I went to the gallery afterward with the prints. Grant's photograph was in a different sleeve, which I did not put on the public table.

Opportunity / murderer: I set the portrait station to make its exposures and used a remote release while moving through the gallery. Before the toast I was checking the backup print Grant wanted gone. I had brought his approved donor photographs to the salon earlier. He had mistaken approving those photographs for controlling the rest.

Method / innocent: The orange tether in the behind-camera film runs to my camera. I stay beside it through the whole 6:49–6:55 brass overlay. The wide film shows me beside the camera; shutter timestamps record the exposures.



I borrowed the setup key for a print sleeve and used linen on the lens. The hidden backup is in the unmarked sleeve.

Method / murderer: The orange tether stayed at the portrait station while I used the remote release. I borrowed the preparation key for a print sleeve and kept the lens cloth. The backup of Grant's meeting is in the unmarked sleeve. Camera timestamps tell you when an image happened. They do not always tell you where the photographer stood.

Innocent Coming Clean: I retained the print after agreeing to delete the camera copy. The continuous orange-tether film, with its clock corrected, accounts for my body rather than merely my shutter. Grant disliked the surviving photograph. I intended to keep it. I did not poison him to prevent another request for deletion.

Murderer Coming Clean: The remote release produced photographs while I went to the salon. I took the toxin on the lens cloth and wiped Grant's coupe. My photograph showed a meeting he wanted erased; I had decided to erase its subject instead. I was not the operator in the wide film. I hoped the exposure times would make you forget to look behind it.

Technical support / F4: Portrait station / BRASS clock.

Robin Banks

Victim relationship: Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Hidden complication: You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Motive / innocent: I put the protest stickers in the brochures. Grant had already had me removed from another event and threatened legal action tonight. He wanted a room celebrating ownership without asking how the owner acquired it. The stickers were peaceful and intentional. I brought enough pens that nobody could claim the petition lacked a practical way to sign.

Motive / murderer: The brochure stickers are mine. Grant threatened another removal and a lawsuit if I disrupted the unveiling. He called



questions about restitution harassment. I had been circulating the petition anyway. He could afford to delay an ownership case longer than the families seeking answers could afford to pursue one.

Opportunity / innocent: I stayed at the return desk from 6:39 to 6:45 for the student group's live teach-in. I put stickers in brochures while explaining the shipping manifest. The whole-room stream kept running. Afterward I brought the petition back to the gallery. Grant had rejected it earlier without reading beyond the heading.

Opportunity / murderer: I supplied a recorded introduction to the student group and distributed brochures in the gallery before the toast. I had approached Grant early about the petition. He said the ownership file was closed. I was checking the manifest against the accession card so the next person repeating that claim could be asked which file they meant.

Method / innocent: I used linen to keep the glue off the worktable and borrowed the setup key for a brochure holder. The warning about returning what was taken was not my wording. My stickers say 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB.' Grant's lawyers would prefer it to be a subject nobody mentions at dinner.

Method / murderer: I borrowed the setup key for the brochure holder and retained the glue cloth. My stickers say 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB.' I had marked the shipping chain on a copy of the manifest. Grant wanted me to give him that copy; he had no interest in giving the families the original ownership documents.

Innocent Coming Clean: The protest was mine. The student group's retained return-desk stream keeps me there through the contamination interval. I wanted Grant alive to face an ownership claim he had spent years avoiding. My questions survive him, but I did not decide that his death would answer them.

Murderer Coming Clean: I sent the students a recording while I moved through the gallery. The glue cloth carried stolen toxin to Grant's coupe. I wanted him unable to bury another restitution demand under a legal threat. I poisoned him instead of making him answer. The cause remains necessary. What I did in its name cannot be excused by it.



Technical support / F4: Return desk / SECURITY clock.

Penny Pincher

Victim relationship: One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Hidden complication: You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Motive / innocent: The decorative object belonged to my family. Grant bought it through a private sale we contested in writing. I brought the letters to embarrass him in front of witnesses. He preferred a label thanking him for generosity. I have never enjoyed being told how grateful I ought to feel about somebody else displaying our possessions.

Motive / murderer: Grant called the object his generous gift. My family called the sale manipulative and kept the correspondence. I brought it tonight. He wanted to discuss the matter privately, where he could describe the letters as an old misunderstanding. I wanted him to read them with somebody else listening.

Opportunity / innocent: I went into the object-study room to compare the family monogram with the letter. Its security door stayed shut until the inspection ended. I came out and took the letter back to the gallery entrance. The match was clear. Grant's enthusiasm for private discussion had become rather less mysterious.

Opportunity / murderer: I compared the letter with the catalog photograph at the gallery table. I had looked at the object earlier and wanted to copy the monogram accurately. Grant had seen the correspondence in his salon before the glass arrived. Before the toast I was deciding which paragraph to ask him to explain publicly.

Method / innocent: The object-study room had three blue seals over its side panels. They stayed intact while I was inside from 6:39 to 6:45. The family monogram matched the letter. I also removed the sale receipt from Grant's



archive folder. He already knew what it said; I wanted an original document when he described the sale to the room.

Method / murderer: The catalog photograph shows the family monogram clearly enough to compare at a table. I removed the sale receipt from Grant's folder and kept it with our letter. He had retained the correspondence and still intended to tell the story without mentioning it. I wanted him to explain the price as well as the acquisition.

Innocent Coming Clean: I took the receipt and intended to embarrass Grant with the family letters. The object-study room log and intact blue seals keep me inside during the contamination interval. I wanted the object returned and the disputed sale acknowledged. I did not poison the person whose explanation I had finally arranged to hear.

Murderer Coming Clean: I used the catalog photograph, not the sealed object-study room. The linen around my letter carried the reference toxin to Grant's coupe. He had bought the object cheaply and our silence even more cheaply. I wanted restitution. I chose revenge and told myself that the two could be made to resemble each other.

Technical support / F4: Object-study room / SECURITY clock.

Justin Tyme

Victim relationship: Grant fed you several flattering claims for an earlier profile that you later discovered were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if you corrected them.

Hidden complication: You are preparing a correction that will also make you look embarrassingly credulous.

Motive / innocent: Grant fed me a splendid origin story for the museum building. The old deed does not agree with it. My blog printed his version, so the correction makes me look gullible as well as making him look dishonest. He threatened to cut off access if I published. I had already started tracing who owned the lot before his family did.

Motive / murderer: I printed Grant's building story before checking the deed. That was my mistake. The correction would expose his exaggeration



and my willingness to believe it. He threatened to end my access to the museum. I had a folder of earlier owners, and he had a plaque that carefully omitted them.

Opportunity / innocent: I used the fixed archive-office telephone for the radio call-in from 6:39 to 6:45. I read the old parcel line aloud and corrected Grant's building story. The station kept the whole exchange. Afterward I went back to the gallery with the deed copy. Publishing a correction is easier once you have already said it on the radio.

Opportunity / murderer: I left a recorded correction with the radio producer and checked the deed copy at the gallery table before the toast. I had taken Grant the earlier clipping in his salon. It still contained his version. I was trying to get the parcel description into one readable paragraph before another donor supplied an anecdote to replace it.

Method / innocent: I copied the deed pages without the usual archive request. The correction concerns who owned the lot before the museum, not whether the museum exists. Grant's clipping put his family at the beginning of the story. The parcel line had earlier owners. I left the clipping flat beside the deed so nobody could say I had misquoted him.

Method / murderer: The old clipping and deed copy were in an archive sleeve. I had copied pages without filing the request. Grant wanted the correction held while he checked it; I had already checked it against a document older than his family anecdote. He threatened my access. I kept a second copy for the work I would have to do afterward.

Innocent Coming Clean: I published a credulous profile and copied archive pages without permission. The station's fixed-line parcel discussion accounts for me while the coupe was exposed. The correction was already public before Grant drank. I still owe readers a better account of the building. I did not kill a source to finish one.

Murderer Coming Clean: The radio station had a recording. I was at the gallery table, then the salon, carrying the stolen toxin on the clipping cloth. I wiped Grant's coupe before returning to the deed. He could cut off every door I used for research. I decided to close his future instead. My correction was necessary; his murder was my choice.



Technical support / F4: Archive-office radio line / SECURITY clock.

Minnie Malist

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected.

Hidden complication: You secretly changed the cue again after approval, causing the eerie light flickers guests noticed during Act I.

Motive / innocent: Grant demanded a ghastly lighting cue, Frank objected, and my payment became the hostage. I changed the cue after approval. The flicker was mine. He wanted me to apologize for disobeying him while accepting responsibility for whatever his version would have done. I had invoices from people who could not pay their rent with donor gratitude.

Motive / murderer: I changed the lighting cue after approval because Grant's version was awful. He threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected. The flicker you saw was my late edit. Grant intended to blame the designer and stop the check. I was very tired of producing an evening for a man who thought payment was another creative note.

Opportunity / innocent: I stayed at the show-control desk running the manual tests before the toast. The pink worklight was on because I had forgotten the overhead cue again. I returned to the gallery after the test finished. Grant's latest demand was beside the unpaid invoice, where I could keep both sources of irritation in view.

Opportunity / murderer: I put the console into its saved test sequence and watched the gallery lights before the toast. The pink worklight stayed on at the desk. I had discussed Grant's demands at his salon earlier and carried his marked cue sheet with me. He had added another change in the margin after approving the previous one.

Method / innocent: The pink-worklight recording and manual-contact log run 6:49 to 6:55 on the brass overlay. My hands stay on the test faders. I had used the setup key for linen screens earlier. I changed the cue without approval, but my console cannot operate the security curtain. Please let each machine retain responsibility for its own disaster.



Method / murderer: The saved test sequence can run without my hands on the faders. I took a linen screen with the setup key and kept Grant's marked cue sheet. My console is separate from the curtain controller. The unauthorized lighting edit remains mine. I wanted the room to look good even if the person paying for it refused to behave.

Innocent Coming Clean: I changed the cue and caused the flicker. The manual-contact log and desk camera, with their overlay corrected, keep me at the console during the contamination interval. They also distinguish my lights from the security curtain. I wanted payment and a competent show. I did not poison the donor to obtain either.

Murderer Coming Clean: The console ran its saved test while I left the desk. The linen screen carried the stolen reference sample; I wiped Grant's coupe during the private-service interval. His marked cue sheet let me look like an exhausted producer making one more correction. I killed the man withholding payment. The lighting change was only the smaller secret.

Technical support / F4: Show desk / BRASS clock.